Ellen Ying-Shiou Kao

Formerly known as Yun-Ju Kao

Department of Political Science, Soochow University, Taiwan
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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Democratic accountability; legislative studies; political behavior; civil society; Japanese and Taiwanese politics; mixed methods analysis

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Soochow University *August 2022- present*
Adjunct Assistant Professor

Soochow University *August 2025- July 2026*
Postdoctoral Researcher

Institute of Political Science at Academia Sinica *January 2023- June 2024*
Postdoctoral Research Fellow

EDUCATION

Aichi University

Ph.D., Chinese Studies, 2022
Dissertation: Chang Tso-lin and Railway Construction (in Japanese; original title: 張作霖と鉄道建設)
Advisor: Akira Miyoshi

Soochow University

Ph.D., Political Science, 2019 (Field: Comparative Politics and International Relations)
Dissertation: Government Durability: The Case of Japan (1947-2018)
Advisor: Shiow-Duan Hawang

Soochow University

M.A., Political Science, 2015 (Field: Comparative Politics and International Relations)

Dissertation: The Impact of the Electoral System Reform in House of Representatives on the Liberal Democratic Party Faction

Soochow University

B.A., Japanese Language and Culture, 2013

Minor: Political Science

PUBLICATIONS

Articles in Peer-Reviewed Journals

1. **Voter Preferences for Legislators' Effort Allocation: Evidence from Taiwan** *published in Legislative Studies Quarterly* 51.2 (2026): e70070. (with Nick Lin; SSCI)

2. **Resilience to Online Disinformation: The Role of Civil Society Organizations.** *published in Polish Political Science Yearbook* 54.3 (2025): 89-104. (with Agnieszka Bejma).

3. **A Comparative Study of the Ideology between Taiwan and China through Content Analysis of the Compulsory Education Textbooks**. *published in ICCS Modern Sinology Journal* 14.2 (2021): 41-53. (with Shen-Lin Hou). (in Chinese)

4. **The Conception of China-Japan-South Korea Trilateral Cooperation in the post-COVID-19 Era**. *published in Journal of Northeastern Asia Studies* 4 (2021): 70-83. (with Hui Guo). (in Chinese)

5. **The Measures in Response to COVID-19 of the Japanese Government in the post-COVID-19 Era with Spatial Analysis**. *published in Academic Journal of Jinchu* 21.6 (2020): 5-14. (in Chinese)

6. **The Pursuit of Abe's Long-term Administration: in the Perspective of Electoral Politics.** *published in Pacific Journal* 26.9 (2018): 12-23. (with Guang-Tao Wang; CSSCI) (in Chinese)

Articles in Editor-Reviewed Journals

1. **The Relationship between Japan and Manchuria through the Policies of the Railway during Chang Tso-Lin and Chang Hsueh-Liang Periods.** *published in Aichi Ronso: The Journal of the Student Council, Aichi Univ. Graduate School* 111 (2021): 49-64. (in Japanese)

2. **"Taiwanization" of the Republic of China in the 21st Century.** *published in Aichi Ronso: The Journal of the Student Council, Aichi Univ. Graduate School* 110 (2021): 1-21. (in Japanese)

3. **Meiji Restoration and the Railway Construction in Manchuria.** *published in Aichi Ronso: The Journal of the Student Council, Aichi Univ. Graduate School* 109 (2020): 1-16. (in Japanese)

Book Chapters (peer-reviewed)

1. **The Relational Ideology and Conservatism through Content Analysis of Japanese Security Issues**" in Shi-lei Duan and Zi-Qing Xie. (eds) *Religious Research as a National Security Imperative*. Beijing: Religion Culture Press. (2022; with Guang-Tao Wang). (in Chinese)

Policy Publication

1. **Cost of Politics in Taiwan.** Westminster Foundation for Democracy. (2025) https://costofpolitics.net/asia-and-the-pacific/taiwan

2. **Independent Initial Review of Taiwan Open Parliament Action Plan 2021-2024**. National Development Council. (with Nodar Kherkheulidze, and Dea Tsartsidze; 2023) https://www.ly.gov.tw/Pages/Detail.aspx?nodeid=46288&pid=229071

RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

Research under Review

1. "Factionalism, Government Stability, and Electoral System: The Case of Japan"

2. "An Exploration of Voters' Preferences for Candidate Traits: A Comparative Study of Central and Local Elections" (with Nick Lin)

Working Papers

1. "Legislative Oversight and Budgeting in Taiwan during Covid-19"

2. "Political Participation of the Lying-flat Generation: Insights from Taiwan"

3. "Translating the Legislature: Knowledge Infrastructure, Epistemic Authority, and the Politics of Parliamentary Transparency"

POLICY EXPERIENCE

Westminster Foundation for Democracy (WFD), the United Kingdom

Project Researcher *November 2024- March 2025*

- Sole researcher and author of the Taiwan study in WFD's global *Cost of Politics* program; responsible for research design, project execution, and the final report.

Project Researcher *December 2021- March 2022*

- Member of the research team for *Democratic Resilience in Taiwan*, an internal WFD study; contributed to fieldwork and analysis, and briefed diplomatic and representative offices in Taipei on the findings.

National Development Council, Taiwan (R.O.C.)

Researcher *November 2022- May 2023*

- Co-authored the Independent Initial Review of Taiwan's Open Parliament Action Plan 2021–2024 with two international experts, serving as the Taiwan-side researcher: conducted stakeholder consultations across government, the Legislative Yuan, and civic-technology communities, and assessed commitments on open parliamentary data, disclosure, and civic participation.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS AND INVITED TALKS

Workshop Parliaments in the Global South: Challenges and Transformations	*2026*
EAJS Conference	*2026*
IPSA Annual Meeting	*2025*
APSA Annual Meeting	*2025*

TPSA Annual Meeting	2022, 2025
Institute of Political Science, Academia Sinica	2023, 2025
g0v civic tech community with information transparency	2025
The International Conference on Parliamentary Studies	2022 - 2025
PNC Annual Conferenfce	2024
The Democratic Governance in Poland and Taiwan	2024
European Research Center on Contemporary Taiwan (ERCCT) Workshop	2023

TEACHING AND SUPERVISION

Japanese Government and Politics

Soochow University, BA course, Autumn 2026/2027

Research Methods

Soochow University, MA course, Spring 2026

Participatory Democracy

Soochow University, BA course, Spring 2027

Soochow University, BA course, Spring 2026

Soochow University, BA course, Spring 2023

Culture and Democracy

Soochow University, BA course, Autumn 2024/2025

Human Rights and Democracy

Soochow University, BA course, Autumn 2022/2023

LANGUAGE & IT KNOWLEDGE

Languages	Mandarin (Native), English (Fluent), Japanese (Fluent)
Statistical Tools	STATA, R
Other IT Skills	Geoda, QGIS